Megan C. Petersohn

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I am a wildlife ecologist and M.Sc. candidate with extensive carnivore-ungulate field experience and a commitment to collaborative, community-engaged research. I am broadly interested in researching how large mammals move, interact, and coexist across working landscapes, integrating spatial ecology, predator-prey dynamics, and human-wildlife interactions to inform conservation and management.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Biology
University of British Columbia at Okanagan, Kelowna, BC *May 2024 – Present*
Thesis: Understanding white-tailed deer (sekwtúps) range expansion in the Columbia Mountains of British Columbia
Advisor: Dr. Tal Avgar

Bachelor of Arts in Biology and Neuroscience
Augustana University, Rock Island, Illinois *August 2011 – May 2015*
Minor: Spanish
Honors: Dean's List, Lillian E. Paulson Award

RESEARCH EXPERTISE

Quantitative Ecology and Data Management: R, GitHub version control, GIS (ArcGIS/Collector), spatial data processing, long-term dataset management, and transparent and reproducible analytical workflows.

Field-Based Predator-Prey Research: Multi-platform (fixed-wing, helicopter, watercraft, snow travel, and extended backcountry travel) tracking, live-capture, and telemetry of carnivores and ungulates; remote camera deployment and servicing; GPS-cluster investigations, necropsies, biological sampling, and long-term wildlife research.

Community Partnerships and Engagement: Ongoing research collaboration, knowledge exchange, and youth engagement initiatives with Splatsin; prior fieldwork conducted in partnership with the White Mountain Apache Tribe and San Carlos Apache Tribe; and implementation of conflict mitigation (hazing, deterrents, fladry, fencing) and public engagement strategies across high-conflict working landscapes, including cross-cultural communication with ranchers, landowners, agency partners, and community collaborators.

Teaching, Mentorship, and Scientific Communication: Teaching Assistant (Biology), undergraduate supervision, scientific writing and conference presentations, collaborative research, academic and field leadership, and inclusive instruction and mentorship, including experience supporting students and adults with disabilities.

SELECTED RESEARCH APPOINTMENTS

Yellowstone Wolf, Cougar, and Elk Project
National Park Service, Yellowstone National Park, Wyoming *November 2022 – April 2023*
Contributed to a 28-year continuous winter predator-prey study through GPS-cluster investigations, behavioral observation, and camera monitoring in one of North America's most intensively studied wolf systems, a landscape shaped by tourism and park-boundary management complexities.

Wolf and Deer Project
U.S. Geological Survey, Ely, Minnesota *July 2020 – August 2022*
Managed the final phase of one of the world's longest-running wolf-deer research programs, conducting aerial telemetry, live-capture, necropsies, winter tracking, and long-term data management as the sole field technician within a mixed wilderness-human landscape of the Superior National Forest and Boundary Waters region.

Mexican Wolf Recovery Program
U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service, Alpine, Arizona *October 2018 – April 2019 and January – May 2020*
Conducted live-capture and monitoring of endangered Mexican wolves within a highly contested recovery landscape, implementing conflict mitigation strategies across agency and ranching contexts, at the interface of carnivore recovery in the Gila National Forest.

Isle Royale Wolf Introduction *May – August 2019*
State University of New York College of Environmental Science and Forestry, Isle Royale National Park, Michigan
Performed over 100 GPS-cluster investigations during the first year of wolf reintroduction to a roadless island ecosystem, documenting early predation patterns, prey selection, and emerging social dynamics among reintroduced individuals in a globally recognized predator-prey system.

ADDITIONAL RESEARCH APPOINTMENTS

National Park Service, Isle Royale National Park, Michigan — *March 2020*
New Mexico Department of Game and Fish, Mount Taylor, New Mexico — *May – September 2018*
Wisconsin Department of Natural Resources, Dodgeville, Wisconsin — *November 2017 – May 2018*
Mississippi State University, Baraga, Michigan — *April – November 2017*

PUBLICATIONS & MANUSCRIPTS

Martinig, A.R., Burk, S.L.P., Drobniak, S.M., Perry, I., Morrison, K., Petersohn, M. et al. 2025. Dragon kill points: applying a transparent working template to relieve authorship stress. EcoEvoRxiv. doi:10.32942/X2W05K.

Petersohn, Megan (2023). An Old Place with New Songs. *International Wolf*, 33(3), 28-30.

Petersohn, M.C., and S.M. Barber-Meyer (2022). A Rare Window into an Ancient Struggle. *International Wolf*, 32(2), 26-27.

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

Understanding White-Tailed Deer (sekʷtúps) Range Expansion in the Columbia Mountains
Petersohn, M.C., Serrouya, R., Bergeron, C., Boutin, S., Christian, A., and Tal Avgar
Presented at the Columbia Mountains Institute (CMI) Researcher's Forum, Revelstoke, BC (Sept 2025), and the Wildlife Society (TWS) International Conference, Edmonton, Alberta (Oct 2025)

Predator Reduction: Effects on Cervids
Megan Petersohn and Tal Avgar, University of British Columbia at Okanagan
Presented at the WAFWA Deer & Elk Workshop, Nanaimo, British Columbia (June 2025)

Wolf Genetics and Persistence of Scat and Radiocollars
Megan Petersohn, Shannon Barber-Meyer, Kristy Pilgrim, Inga Ortloff, U.S. Geological Survey, Ely, Minnesota
Poster presented at International Wolf Symposium, Minneapolis, Minnesota (Oct 2022)

TEACHING & SUPERVISING

Undergraduate Research Supervisor
University of British Columbia at Okanagan, Kelowna, BC — *September 2024 – Present*
Mentoring four undergraduate researchers in analytical and field components of wildlife ecology projects, including data management, wildlife classification and photo tagging, statistical analysis, presentation and manuscript preparation.

Teaching Assistant (Anatomy and Physiology)
University of British Columbia at Okanagan, Kelowna, BC — *January 2025 – May 2025*
Supported undergraduate biology instruction through laboratory teaching, grading, and student mentoring.

Biology Tutor
McHenry County College, Crystal Lake, IL — *November 2015 – April 2017 and October 2019 – January 2020*
Tutored undergraduate students in biology, ecology, microbiology, anatomy, and physiology, including individualized instruction through accessibility services.

COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP

President of UBCO's Backcountry Hunters and Anglers (BHA) Collegiate Club
Kelowna, British Columbia — *September 2024 – Present*

Founder of Augustana College Fishing Club
Quad Cities, Illinois — *Spring 2014 – May 2015*

CERTIFICATIONS, TRAININGS, & SKILLS

Professional: Aircrew Member (HAZMAT); Chemical Immobilization and Handling (WI DNR); IQCS Wildland Firefighter (FFT2, BTOP); Minnesota Trapping Certification; Minnesota Snowmobile Safety; Motorboat Operator Certification Course (MOCC); Non-Lethal Use of Firearms; Open Water Scuba Diver (PADI); Wilderness First Aid (WFA)

Personal: fishing; hunting; canoeing; kayaking; backcountry skiing; wildlife photography; creative writing